

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

9th APR, 2019

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

15th WEEK



CHINA'S FORAYS IN IOR ... FOCUS ON INDIA-MALDIVES TIES

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

9th APRIL, 2019

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IAS PRELIMS 2019



BRAINSTORMING

WITH **REWIND** OF
10 MONTHS EDITORIALS



WITH PRELIMS FOCUS

MODULE - 1



1

Maldivian wave

President Solih consolidates power with his MDP's victory in parliamentary polls

The administration of Maldives President Ibrahim Mohamed Solih has received a shot in the arm with the parliamentary election held over the weekend. His Maldivian Democratic Party is poised to garner more than 60 out of 87 seats, paving the way for easy passage of bills and a policy agenda with a realistic chance of implementation. Mr. Solih, whose pro-democracy government assumed power after a presidential election in September 2018, has sought to break with the regime of his predecessor Abdullah Yameen, which had propelled the Indian Ocean nation into Beijing's economic embrace, described by some as "debt-trap diplomacy". While Mr. Solih was quick to signal the shift in his government's priorities, not least by ensuring that Prime Minister Narendra Modi was the chief guest at the presidential inauguration, his agenda has been hobbled by resistance from lawmakers on certain bills aimed at the previous administration. Specifically, Parliament Speaker Qasim Ibrahim, the head of the Jumhooree Party, a coalition partner of the MDP, declined to support a vote on a bill aimed at recognizing stolen assets and looking into unresolved murders. With the election throwing up a single-party majority, Mr. Solih can push through his agenda with fewer stumbling blocks.

So far as India's interests in the Indian Ocean Region are concerned, warm bilateral ties between New Delhi and Male are a high priority after five years of strategic drift that benefited Beijing considerably. According to some analyses, the surging influx of Chinese infrastructure investment under the Yameen administration may have caused the Maldives' national debt to balloon to nearly a quarter of its GDP. As it seeks to unravel this web of Chinese loans, the new leadership has promised that what is owed would be paid. However, the honouring of such debt, especially where it was linked to the grant of land, lease rights and mega-construction projects, will be complicated. As Mr. Solih grapples with these challenges, the assurance that the Maldives has New Delhi's backing would be vital. Already, the elements of a strategic reset with India seem to be falling into place. When Mr. Solih visited India in December, a \$1.4 billion financial assistance package for the Maldives was announced, and the two governments agreed to exempt holders of diplomatic and official passports from visa requirements. Mr. Solih's on Indian grant aid for "high-impact community development projects" have been signed, as also agreements on clean energy and regional maritime security. So long as the new government presses on with the urgent task of rebuilding and deepening the Maldives' democratic credentials, there is hope for political stability and economic development across the 1,192 island archipelago and the wider IOR.

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

India and its neighborhood- relations.

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Critically analyze the forays of China in the Indian Ocean Region. In this context, examine the need for revitalized bilateral ties between India and Maldives.

1 Maldivian wave

President Solih consolidates power with his MDP's victory in parliamentary polls

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GWADAR PORT

CHITTAGONG PORT

DJIBOUTI PORT

KYAUKPYU PORT

HAMBANTOTA PORT

MOMBASA PORT

MALDIVES

ASSUMPTION ISLAND

CHAGOS ISLANDS

AGALEGA ISLANDS

REUNION ISLAND

North
Pacific
Ocean

South
Atlantic
Ocean

Indian Ocean

AUSTRALIA



IBRAHIM MOHAMED SOLIH
PRESIDENT, MALDIVES

- Maldivian Democratic Party is poised to win more than 60 out of 87 seats.
- It paves the way for easy passage of Bills and policy agenda with realistic chance of implementation.
- It facilitates Mr. Solih to push his agenda with fewer stumbling blocks.

MALDIVES

Indian Ocean

North
Pacific
Ocean

South
Atlantic
Ocean

REVITALIZING THE BILATERAL TIES ... RECENT DEVELOPMENTS!

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MoUs on Indian grant aid for high-impact community development projects were signed.

4

The two Governments agreed to exempt holders of diplomatic and official passports from visa requirements.

**3**

When Mr. Solih visited India in December, \$1.4 billion of financial assistance package for Maldives was announced.

**MALDIVES
CRUCIAL IN
HALTING CHINA!**

1

Warm bilateral ties between New Delhi and Male are high priority after five years of drift that benefited China considerably.

2

Some analysts say, influx of Chinese infrastructure investment under Abdulla Yameen Government may have caused the Maldives national debt to raise to almost a quarter of its GDP.



There is a strategic need for India to take bilateral ties to the highest possible level in view of Chinese expansion in the Indian Ocean Region.

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FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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